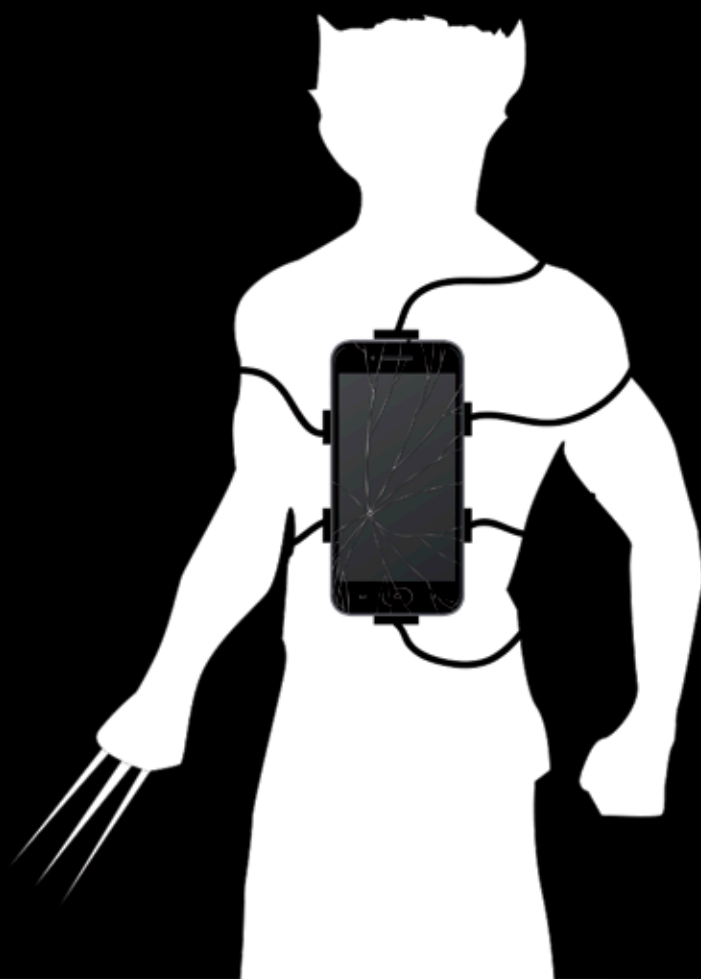




SELF REPAIRING MATERIALS

WOULD YOU LIKE IT IF YOUR GADGETS COULD HEAL JUST LIKE THE WOLVERINE?

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When a smartphone or a laptop is dropped from someone's hands, one of the universally felt emotions is that of severe anguish. Several questions immediately pop into the head - did the screen break? Is it working? How much is this going to cost? Will my new phone have scratches and dents now? In fact, Motorola based an entire smartphone's design to tackle this in the Moto X Force by implementing a shatter proof screen. But is sheer brute strength all that can be done to make gadgets, or at least parts of gadgets, damage proof?

Self repairing technology is not an entirely new scientific breakthrough right now. Actually, if you have been delving around smartphones and following tech-

nology updates for more than a year or two now, this cannot be the first time you are hearing about self repairing tech. But it is about time that this breakthrough escapes the labs and enters mainstream store shelves. Let us explore what it is all about and how close we are to damage proof gadgets that can at least give themselves first aid after an accident.

What does it actually mean?

Before we begin, let us clarify that self repairing tech does not imply T-1000 level healing, where your broken dis-



Definitely not a good day!

membered gadgets gather themselves together and somehow become one again. Nor does it cover intelligent robots that can put themselves together. What self repairing tech in its current state of the art does is mostly surface repair, which highly depends on what material the gadget's surface is made out of.

Any material stops working the way it is supposed to due to three factors -

- Decay - Over time, factors like light, heat, micro organisms, cause certain material to outlive their usability sooner than they would unaffected.
- Fatigue - Physical usage factors like friction and wear-tear
- Defects - Under suddenly applied force and stress, some materials show cracks and fractures, or holes that spread very rapidly.

The first two factors are actually unavoidable for most material and can